



RKDF University, Bhopal
Open Distance Learning (ODL) Material
Semester –II
Subject- COMPUTER FUNDAMENTAL
Syllabus

Units	Topic	Duration (In Hours)	Marks
I	Computer Fundamentals –Generations of Computer , Advantage and Disadvantage of Computer, Block Diagram of a Computer, Description of Different Parts of a Computer. Formatting a given File by using undo/redo, repeat ,cut, copy, paste, delete, duplicate and clone utilities	12	20
II	System Software and Application Software MS office Introduction to MS Office ,Word Processing Software ,Electronic Spreadsheet, MS Paint. Formatting and Editing a document, Saving and Printing a given document.	12	20
III	PageMaker Introduction to various versions, concepts and applications of Page Maker Guides and rulers .Drawing tools. fill and outlines. Creating and Opening a document in page maker. Insertion of text and graphics in a given document from external source.	12	20
IV	Photo Shop – History and Introduction, the file menu, the tools , Drawing lines and shapes .Photo editing/inserting starting with Setting Up ,introduction of Layers, Understanding Design principles and color theory.	12	20
V	Coral Draw – Drawing - lines, shapes. Inserting pictures, objects, tables, templates, Use of various tools such as Pick tools, Zoom tools ,Free hand tool, square tool, rectangle tool, Text tool, fill tool etc. Adding various symbols to Drawing and creating pattern, Use of mode edit tools i.e.to line to curve,to stretch and rotate	12	20

UNIT – I

Computer Fundamentals –Generations of Computer

The First Generation of Computers- (the 1940s-1950s)

1. The main electronic component used in the computers of the 1940s to 1950s era were vacuum tubes.
2. The main memory storing units were magnetic tapes and magnetic drums.
3. The machine language was used as the programming language.
4. The sizes used to be very large which could take up entire rooms and the speed was very slow.
5. The only input/output devices were paper tape and punched cards.
6. Around 100 different vacuum tubes were used in order to produce the computers.
7. Examples are UNIVAC1, ENIAC, IBM 701 and IBM 650, etc.

The Second Generation of Computers- (the 1950s-1960s)

1. The main electronic component used in the computers of the 1950s to 1960s era were transistors.
2. The main memory storing units were magnetic tape or disk and magnetic core.
3. The assembly language was used as the programming language.
4. The sizes were smaller as compared to those of the first generation and they used to consume low power and generate less heat.
5. There was an improvement in speed.
6. The input/output devices were magnetic tape and punched cards.
7. Examples are IBM 1401, IBM 7094 AND IBM 7090, UNIVAC 1107, and so on.

The Third Generation of Computers- (the 1960s-1970s)

1. The main electronic components used in the computers of the era 1060s to 1970s were integrated circuits ICs.
2. The memory storing units were the magnetic disk or take and a large magnetic core.
3. High-level languages such as BASIC, COBOL, Pascal were used as the programming language.

4. The sizes were smaller and efficient and the computers were called minicomputers.
5. There was an improvement in reliability and speed as compared to the second generation of computers.
6. The input/output devices were keyboards, magnetic tape monitor, printer, etc.
7. Examples are IBM 370, IBM 360, UNIVAC 1108 and so on.

The Fourth Generation of Computers- (1970s-present)

1. The main electronic components used in the fourth generation of computers are microprocessors and very large scale integration (VLSI).
2. When thousands of transistors are attached to a single microchip, it is known as VLSI.
3. Semiconductor memory storage units such as RAM, ROM, etc were introduced.
4. RAM (random-access memory)- Temporarily stores the programs and data and the contents are lost when the computer is shut down.
5. ROM (read-only memory)- Permanently stores the data and programs and the contents are retained even after shutting down the computer.
6. High-level languages such as C#, JAVA, Python, JavaScript are used as programming languages.
7. The sizes are smaller and the speed has improved.
8. The input/output devices are a monitor, mouse, keyboard, printer, and so on.
9. Examples are STAR 1000, APPLE II, IBM PC, and so on

The Fifth Generation of Computers- (present and the future)

1. The main electronic components that are used in the present generation of computers is Artificial Intelligence which uses the parallel processing method and the Ultra-Large Scale Integration (ULSI).
2. The fifth generation of computers understands the natural human language.
3. The speeds are really fast and the sizes are also small.
4. The fifth-generation computers are portable and have a huge storage capacity.
5. The input/output devices are keyboards, monitors, touchscreen pens, printers, light scanners, and so on.
6. Examples are laptops, desktops, tablets, smartphones, etc.

Advantage and Disadvantage of Computer

Advantages of Computer

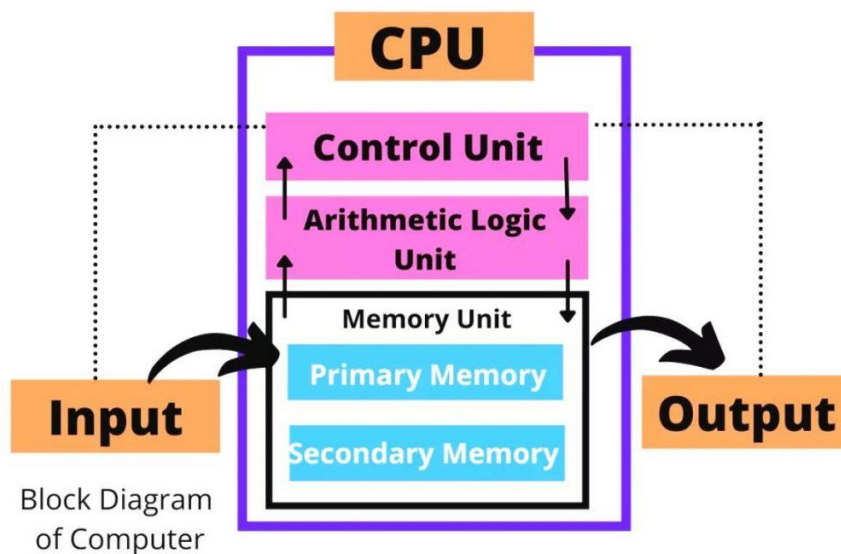
- **Multitasking:** Multitasking is one of the main advantages of computers. A person can do multiple tasks, and multiple operations at the same time, and calculate numerical problems within a few seconds. The computer can perform millions or trillions of work in one second.
- **Speed:** Now the computer isn't just a calculating device. Now a day's computer has a vital role in human life. One of the most advantages of computers is their incredible speed, which helps human to finish their task in a few seconds.
- **Cost/ Stores huge:** Amount of knowledge it's a coffee cost solution. A person can save huge data within a coffee budget. A centralized database for storing information is a major advantage that will reduce costs.
- **Accuracy:** One of the essential advantages of computers is they will perform not only calculations but also with accuracy.
- **Data Security:** Protecting digital data is understood as data security.
- **Task completer:** Completes tasks that might be impossible for humans to complete.
- **Communication:** The computer helps the user better understand and communicate with other devices.
- **Productivity:** The level of productivity gets automatically doubled as the computer can do the work very fast.
- **Reduces workload:** Information is often accessed by more than one person with the necessity for work to be duplicated.
- **Reliability:** Computers can perform the same sort of work repeatedly without throwing up errors thanks to tiredness or boredom, which are quite common among humans.
- **Storage:** The pc has an in-built memory where it can store an outsized amount of knowledge. You can also store data in auxiliary storage devices.

Disadvantages of computer

- **Virus and hacking attacks:** A virus may be a worm and hacking is just unauthorized access over a computer for a few illicit purposes. Viruses can go to another system from email attachments, viewing an infected website advertisement, through removable devices like USBs, etc.
- **Online Cyber Crimes:** Online cyber-crime means computers and networks may have been utilized in order to commit a crime. Cyberstalking and fraud are the points that come under online cyber crimes.
- **Reduction in employed opportunity:** Mainly past generation hasn't used the pc or they need the knowledge of computers they faced an enormous problem when computers came into the field.
- **High Cost:** Computers are expensive. Even the foremost affordable computers are still very expensive for the typical person in South Africa. Since computers empower people.
- **Distractions/disruptions:** If you've got ever spent hours browsing the web or watching videos on YouTube, then you recognize how distracting computers can be! Because of their high entertainment value.
- **Increases waste and impacts the environment:** With the speed at that computer and other electronics get replaced, all of the old devices that get thrown away have a big impact on the environment.

- **Health Problems:** Prolonged use of computers can lead to various health Hazards. Too much sitting near the screen results in eye strain and drying up of the eyes. Also, prolonged sitting leads to neck and back problems.

Block Diagram of a Computer



Description of Different Parts of a Computer:

A computer is composed of various hardware components that work together to perform various tasks. Here's a brief description of the different parts of a computer:

1. **Motherboard:** The motherboard is the main circuit board that connects all the other components of a computer. It provides the necessary connections for the CPU, RAM, storage devices, and other peripherals.
2. **Central Processing Unit (CPU):** The CPU is the brain of the computer, responsible for executing instructions and performing calculations. It is the primary component that determines the overall performance of the computer.
3. **Random Access Memory (RAM):** RAM is a type of memory that allows the CPU to access data and instructions quickly. It is used to store temporary data and instructions that the CPU needs to access during operation.
4. **Storage Devices:** Storage devices are used to store data and programs permanently. Common storage devices include hard disk drives (HDDs), solid-state drives (SSDs), and optical drives (such as CD-ROMs and DVDs).
5. **Power Supply Unit (PSU):** The PSU is responsible for providing the necessary power to all the components of the computer. It converts alternating current (AC) from the wall outlet to the direct current (DC) required by the various components.

6. **Input/Output (I/O) Devices:** I/O devices are used to interact with the computer. Examples include the keyboard, mouse, monitor, printer, and speakers.
7. **Graphics Processing Unit (GPU):** The GPU is a specialized processor that is primarily responsible for handling graphics-intensive tasks, such as rendering 3D graphics or playing video games.

Formatting a given File by using undo/redo, repeat ,cut, copy, paste, delete, duplicate and clone utilities

Formatting a file using undo/redo, repeat, cut, copy, paste, delete, duplicate, and clone utilities is a common task in many text editors and file management applications. While the specifics may vary depending on the software being used, the general concepts and operations are often similar.

Here's a brief overview of these utilities and how they can be used for file formatting:

1. **Undo/Redo:** These utilities allow you to reverse or reapply actions performed on the file. This can be helpful when you make a mistake or want to experiment with different formatting changes without losing your original work.
2. **Repeat:** The repeat function allows you to quickly apply the same action or sequence of actions multiple times. This can be useful for tasks like applying the same formatting changes across multiple sections of a file.
3. **Cut, Copy, Paste:** These utilities enable you to remove, duplicate, and insert text or other content within the file. This can be useful for rearranging or reorganizing the structure of the file.
4. **Delete:** The delete function allows you to remove selected content from the file. This can be used to clean up unnecessary or unwanted material.
5. **Duplicate:** The duplicate function creates a new copy of the selected content within the file. This can be useful for creating backups or making multiple versions of a section.
6. **Clone:** The clone function is similar to the duplicate function, but it creates a new copy of the selected content that is linked to the original. Changes made to the cloned content will also be reflected in the original.

UNIT-2

System Software and Application Software

System Software: System software is the software that provides the basic functions and control of a computer system. It is responsible for managing the hardware resources, such as the processor, memory, and input/output devices, and facilitating the execution of application software. Some examples of system software include:

1. Operating Systems (e.g., Windows, macOS, Linux)
2. Device Drivers
3. Utility Programs (e.g., file managers, disk defragmenters)
4. Compilers and Interpreters
5. Database Management Systems (DBMS)

System software is typically installed on a computer system during the initial setup or by the manufacturer. It is designed to be low-level, efficient, and provide a stable foundation for running applications.

Application Software: Application software, on the other hand, is the software designed to perform specific tasks or functions for the user. It is built on top of the system software and utilizes the resources provided by the system software. Some examples of application software include:

1. Word processors (e.g., Microsoft Word, Google Docs)
2. Spreadsheet applications (e.g., Microsoft Excel, Google Sheets)
3. Multimedia players (e.g., VLC, Windows Media Player)
4. Web browsers (e.g., Google Chrome, Mozilla Firefox)
5. Accounting software (e.g., QuickBooks, Sage)

Application software is typically installed by the user and is designed to meet specific user needs or perform specific tasks.

Introduction to MS Office:

Microsoft Office is a suite of applications designed to help with productivity and completing common tasks on a computer. You can create and edit documents containing text and images, work with data in spreadsheets and databases, and create presentations and posters.

Word Processing Software:

In order to perform word processing, specialized software (known as a Word Processor) is needed. One example of a Word Processor is Microsoft Word, but other word processing applications are also widely used. Examples include: Microsoft Works Word Processor, Open Office Writer, Word Perfect and Google Drive Document.

Electronic Spreadsheet:

An electronic spreadsheet can be used to automatically perform numerical calculations. Spreadsheet programs are usually set up in the form of a table with rows and columns. Each row and column intersects to form a cell in which data may be stored.

MS Paint:

Microsoft Paint (commonly known as MS Paint or Paint for short) is a simple [raster graphics editor](#) that has been included with all versions of [Microsoft Windows](#). The program opens, modifies and saves image files in [Windows bitmap](#) (BMP), [JPEG](#), [GIF](#), [PNG](#), and single-page [TIFF](#) formats. The program can be in color mode or two-color [black-and-white](#), but there is no [grayscale](#) mode. For its simplicity and wide availability, it rapidly became one of the most used Windows applications, introducing many to painting on a [computer](#) for the first time.

Paint has a few functions not mentioned in the help file: a *stamp mode*, *trail mode*, *regular shapes*, and moving pictures.^[23] For the stamp mode, the user can select a part of the image, hold the [Ctrl](#) key, and move it to another part of the canvas. This, instead of cutting the piece out, creates a copy of it. The process can be repeated as many times as desired, as long as the [Ctrl](#) key is held down. The trail mode works exactly the same, but it uses the [Shift](#) instead of the [Ctrl](#) key.

It is also possible to thicken or thin a line either before or simultaneously while it is being drawn via [Ctrl](#)+[+](#) ([NumPad](#) only) or [Ctrl](#)+[-](#) ([NumPad](#) only).

To crop whitespace or eliminate parts of a graphic, the blue handle in the lower right corner can be dragged to increase canvas size or crop a graphic. Users can also draw perfect shapes (which have a width equal to the height) using any shape tool by holding down the [Shift](#) while dragging.

Older versions of Paint, such as the one bundled with [Windows 3.1](#), feature a color-replace brush, which replaced a single color underneath the brush with another without affecting the rest of the image. In later versions of Paint, the color erase brush may be simulated by selecting the color to be replaced as the primary color, and the one it is replaced with as the secondary color, and then right-click dragging the erase tool.

Formatting and Editing a document, Saving and Printing a given document:

Formatting and Editing a Document: Formatting a document involves the process of applying specific styles, layouts, and visual elements to a document to enhance its appearance and readability. This includes tasks such as:

- Adjusting the font, size, and style
- Applying headings, subheadings, and other text formatting
- Inserting images, tables, and other visual elements
- Adjusting page margins, orientation, and size
- Applying consistent spacing and alignment

Editing a document involves making changes to the content, structure, and presentation of the document. This includes tasks such as:

- Proofreading and correcting spelling, grammar, and punctuation errors
- Reorganizing or rearranging the content

- Modifying or deleting existing text or elements
- Inserting new content, such as additional paragraphs or sections

Saving and Printing a Document: Saving a document ensures that your work is preserved and can be accessed later. This typically involves:

- Choosing a file format (e.g., .docx, .pdf, .txt)
- Selecting a location to save the file (e.g., local drive, cloud storage)
- Providing a meaningful file name

Printing a document allows you to create a physical copy of the document. This process involves:

- Selecting the appropriate printer
- Adjusting print settings (e.g., paper size, orientation, margins)
- Initiating the print command

UNIT-3

Page Maker:

PageMaker was a desktop publishing software application developed by Aldus Corporation and later acquired by Adobe Systems. It was one of the first widely used desktop publishing programs, along with programs like QuarkXPress.

Here are some key points about PageMaker:

1. History:

- PageMaker was first released in 1985 for the Apple Macintosh.
- It was one of the first desktop publishing programs, along with early versions of QuarkXPress.
- In 1994, Adobe Systems acquired Aldus Corporation and incorporated PageMaker into its product lineup.
- PageMaker was discontinued in 2011, and Adobe now primarily focuses on InDesign as its desktop publishing software.

2. Features:

- PageMaker provided a WYSIWYG (What You See Is What You Get) interface for designing and laying out documents.
- It supported features like text formatting, image placement, and basic page layout functions.
- Over the years, it gained support for features like color management, table creation, and support for various file formats.

3. Links:

- Wikipedia page on PageMaker: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Adobe_PageMaker
- Adobe's historical information on PageMaker: <https://www.adobe.com/products/pagemaker.html>
- Aldus Corporation's original PageMaker website (archived): <https://web.archive.org/web/19991127155331/http://www.albus.com/>

Note that PageMaker is not a programming or coding-related question. It was a desktop publishing software application, not a programming language or framework.

Creating and Opening a document in page maker

Creating a new document in PageMaker:

1. Launch the PageMaker application.
2. In the "Start" or "New" dialog box, select "New" to create a new document.
3. Choose the desired page size, orientation, and other settings for your document.
4. Click "OK" to create the new document.

Opening an existing document in PageMaker:

1. Launch the PageMaker application.

2. In the "Start" or "New" dialog box, select "Open" to open an existing document.
3. Navigate to the location of the document you want to open and select it.
4. Click "Open" to open the selected document.

As for providing code examples, PageMaker is a graphical user interface (GUI) application, and it does not involve writing code in the traditional sense. The process of creating and opening a document in PageMaker is typically done through the application's user interface, using various menus, toolbars, and dialog boxes.

Insertion of text and graphics in a given document from external source:

Inserting text and graphics into a document from an external source is a common task in document processing and can be accomplished using various programming languages and libraries. Here's a general overview of the process, and some sample code examples:

1. Inserting Text from an External Source:

- **Microsoft Word (VBA):** You can use the VBA (Visual Basic for Applications) programming language in Microsoft Word to insert text from an external source, such as a text file or a database, into a document.

```
2. Sub InsertTextFromExternal()  
3.     Dim docPath As String  
4.     docPath = "C:\path\to\external\text\file.txt"  
5.     ActiveDocument.Content.Text = GetTextFromFile(docPath)  
6. End Sub  
7.  
8. Function GetTextFromFile(ByVal filePath As String) As String  
9.     Dim fs As Scripting.FileSystemObject  
10.    Dim ts As Scripting.TextStream  
11.    Set fs = New Scripting.FileSystemObject  
12.    Set ts = fs.OpenTextFile(filePath, 1, False)  
13.    GetTextFromFile = ts.ReadAll  
14.    ts.Close  
15. End Function
```

- **Google Docs (Apps Script):** You can use Google Apps Script to insert text from an external source into a Google Docs document.

```
16. function insertTextFromExternal() {  
17.     var doc = DocumentApp.getActiveDocument();  
18.     var textFromFile = getTextFromFile('path/to/external/text/file.txt');  
19.     doc.getBody().setText(textFromFile);  
20. }  
21.  
22. function getTextFromFile(filePath) {  
23.     var file = DriveApp.getFileById('file-id-here');  
24.     return file.getBlob().getDataAsString();  
25. }
```

26. Inserting Graphics from an External Source:

- **Microsoft Word (VBA):** You can use the VBA programming language in Microsoft Word to insert images from an external source into a document.

```
27. Sub InsertGraphicFromExternal()  
28.     Dim picPath As String  
    picPath = "C:\path
```

UNIT-IV

Photo Shop

Photoshop is a powerful image editing software developed and published by Adobe Systems. It is widely used by graphic designers, photographers, and creative professionals for various image manipulation tasks such as photo editing, digital painting, image composition, and more.

Here are some key things to know about Photoshop:

1. Features:

- Layers: Photoshop allows you to work with multiple layers, enabling you to organize and manipulate different elements of an image independently.
- Adjustment Layers: These layers allow you to apply various image adjustments, such as brightness, contrast, and color corrections, without affecting the original image.
- Selection Tools: Photoshop provides a wide range of selection tools, including the Marquee Tool, Lasso Tool, and Magic Wand, which allow you to isolate and work with specific areas of an image.
- Brushes and Painting Tools: Photoshop offers a vast array of brushes and painting tools, enabling you to create digital artwork, retouch images, and add special effects.
- Filters and Effects: Photoshop has a vast library of filters and effects that can be applied to images to achieve various artistic and creative outcomes.

2. Relevant Links:

- Adobe Photoshop official website: <https://www.adobe.com/products/photoshop.html>
- Photoshop tutorials and resources: <https://www.adobe.com/creativecloud/photography/discover/photoshop-tutorials.html>
- Photoshop user forums and communities: <https://community.adobe.com/t5/photoshop/ct-p/ct-photoshop>

Note: Photoshop is not a code-related question, as it is a graphical user interface (GUI) application. It does not involve writing code, but rather uses a visual interface for image editing and manipulation.

Photo editing/inserting starting with Setting Up

Photoshop is a powerful image editing software that offers a wide range of tools and features for various photo editing tasks, including inserting elements into images. Here's a general overview of setting up Photoshop for photo editing and insertion:

Setting Up Photoshop:

1. Open Photoshop: Launch the Photoshop application on your computer.
2. Create a new document: Go to "File" > "New" to create a new document. You can choose the desired size, resolution, and color mode for your project.
3. Adjust the workspace: Photoshop allows you to customize the workspace to suit your needs. You can rearrange the panels, toolbars, and windows to your preference.
4. Familiarize yourself with the tools: Explore the different tools available in the toolbar, such as the selection tools, painting tools, adjustment tools, and layer management tools.

Inserting Elements into Images:

1. Open the image you want to work with: Go to "File" > "Open" and select the image you want to edit.
2. Add a new layer: To insert an element, you'll need to create a new layer. You can do this by clicking the "Create new layer" icon at the bottom of the Layers panel.
3. Import the element: You can import an element (e.g., a logo, image, or graphic) by going to "File" > "Place Embedded" or "File" > "Place Linked." This will allow you to add the element as a new layer in your image.
4. Resize and position the element: Use the transform tools (such as the Move tool or the Free Transform tool) to resize, rotate, and position the inserted element as desired.
5. Blend the element: Adjust the layer blending options, opacity, and other settings to seamlessly integrate the inserted element into the image.
6. Finalize the edits: Once you're satisfied with the result, you can save the edited image by going to "File" > "Save" or "File" > "Save As."

A sales promotion is a marketing strategy in which a business uses a temporary campaign or offer to increase interest or demand in its product or service.

There are many reasons why a business may choose to use a sales promotion (or 'promo'), but the primary reason is to boost sales. Sales boosts may be needed to reach a quota as a deadline approaches, or to raise awareness of a new product.

Let's take a closer look at different types of sales promotions, as well as the pros and cons of using any type of promotion.

Types of sales promotion

There are 12 main types of sales promotions. Not all of them are suited for every business, product, or service, but each one offers unique ways of boosting sales and connecting with customers through different methods of sales psychology. Each is also an interesting take on spin selling and offers a look into sales methodology comparison.

1. Competitions and challenges: Competitions or challenges usually take place on social media, and serve to increase customer engagement as fans try to win a discounted or free product. They usually also result in a large amount of free publicity if the competition or challenge involves sharing the brand on a customer's personal social media account.

2. Product bundles: Product bundles offer a collection of products for an overall discounted rate, as opposed to buying the products individually. Product bundles give customers a reason to buy a larger variety of products, which makes it more likely they will find a product they like and want to buy again.

3. Flash sales: Flash sales are extremely short sales that offer extreme discounts for a limited amount of time. These sales work through creating a sense of urgency and need around your sale.

4. Free trials: Free trials or demos are one of the most common sales promotions and one of the most promising strategies to grow a customer base. Businesses can offer either a limited time with the product or a limited quantity of the product to a first-time buyer at no charge to see if they like it.

5. Free shipping and/or transfers: Free shipping promotions attempt to curb the 70% of customers who abandon their carts when they see the shipping costs. The small loss in shipping fees is usually made up for in happy customer purchases.

6. Free products: Free product promotions work by offering a small free product with the purchase of a larger, mainstream product. This boosts mainstream sales without costing the company too much inventory or revenue.

7. Early-bird or first-purchaser specials: These specials offer discounts to first-time purchasers as a way of welcoming them as customers. Customers are more likely to buy at a discount and because the discount only works once, the company doesn't lose a great deal of revenue.

8. BOGO specials: BOGO, or "buy one, get one free" promotions are primarily used to spread product awareness. Customers can give their extra product to a friend or family member and build a customer base through word of mouth.

9. Coupons and vouchers: Coupons and vouchers reward current customers for their brand loyalty and encourage future purchases. This is especially effective in companies who use punch cards which incentivize customers to make multiple purchases to earn a free product.

10. Upsell specials: Upsell promotions are not as common as the others, but they can still be extremely effective. Upsells give first-time customers a less expensive version of a product to try, and then over time, the sales department works to convince them to purchase the more expensive and more effective option.

11. Subscriptions: Subscriptions are not always considered sales promotion, since they tend to be long-term purchases, but having different amounts of a product available at a different price point is a sales promotion tactic. With a subscription, a customer pays a larger fee upfront for a large amount of product that eventually comes out to less than what they would pay for buying smaller amounts of product individually.

12. Donations: Donations are an excellent way for a company to build credibility and goodwill within the customer base. Most donations work when the company contributes a portion of each sale during a given period to a charitable cause.

Pros of sales promotions

There are many benefits to running a sales promotion in the short term:

1. **Creating new leads:** Sales promotions increase customer acquisition by offering them discounts, free products, free trials, and more. Many potential buyers are willing to try something for a lesser price, and if they like the product they become part of your company's loyal base.
2. **Introducing a new product:** Even extremely successful companies need a little help launching a new product. New customers may need incentives to buy, and long-term customers may be committed to their usual products. Providing a discount or promotion on a new product is a great way to create product awareness without doing a sales presentation.
3. **Selling out overstock:** No one wants to be in this position, but overstocking happens. When it does, a sales promotion can be a useful tool to get rid of inventory while attracting new customers who may not have the overstocked product yet. It's worth noting that there is a line in terms of selling overstock and it's easy to step over into unethical selling.
4. **Rewarding current customers:** Sales success doesn't stop at the first purchase. Nurturing customers over time is essential to keeping brand credibility and loyalty high. Sales promotions are an easy way to provide loyal customers with a discount, voucher, or free product that will continue to keep them engaged with your brand.
5. **Increasing last-minute revenue:** Many companies use sales promotions towards the end of a month or quarter to meet revenue or inventory goals. While not a bad strategy, it's best to use this one sparingly so that customers don't get into the habit of waiting for an expected sale.

Cons of sales promotions

While most sales promotions do successfully increase sales, many also come with a cost. When considering using a sales promotion, it's important to remember the two main risks of the "sales promotion trap":

1. **Sales promotions can devalue your brand:** While it may not be the case for your company, there is a general assumption in the consumer market that if a brand goes on sale, it's because they are having trouble selling that product—it's why we all wait for the day after Valentine's Day to buy discounted chocolate. While promoting a single product in your line might not make a lasting impression, a sales promotion that covers your entire brand might lead customers to think your business is on its last legs.
2. **Sales promotions can make it complicated to sell your product back at its original price point:** Depending on how long your promotion runs, you may attract customers who never paid full price for your product. These customers may then be turned off when you return to full price at the end of a promotion. It's important, therefore, to set strict promotional timelines and leave space in between promotions to make sure your original price is the most consistent one. The other peril of sales promotions to be on the lookout for is cost. According to Harvard Business Review, the average business spends 66 percent of its advertising budget on sales promotions. This type of spending can seriously hurt a business if the promotions are not bringing in enough revenue to counteract the cost when full-price advertising is not given as wide a budget.

Sales promotion example

Perhaps the most common sales promotion is the Black Friday sale. This is an interesting sales promotion to examine because while thousands of companies participate in Black Friday, few participate in the same way.

Some companies run their Black Friday sales within a strict 24 hours time frame, while some spread it over an entire week. Some have in-person offers, or online offers, or are exclusive to one type of purchase.

The important factor in the Black Friday sale is that companies know customers are going to buy. This makes it crucial to have a strong sales promotion strategy and sales territory plan so that you know what you're offering, what your price points are, the exact sales windows, and your audience targets.

Sales promotion strategies

As we've seen, sales promotions come in a large variety and can be used as a sales strategy at any point during the sales process. It's important, therefore, to be aware of best practices, activities, and techniques that will ensure your promotions are successful.

There are three primary strategies for sales promotions:

- **Pull strategy:** The pull strategy tries to get the customer to 'pull' the product away from the company, usually in the form of a discount, BOGO, or another special. This is the most commonly used strategy across the board for all businesses.
- **Push strategy:** The push strategy tries to 'push' the products away from the company towards the customer, usually through B2B sales. Parent companies will reward distributors and retailers for taking additional products off their hands and selling them to the consumers.
- **Hybrid strategy:** As its name suggests, the hybrid strategy is a combination of the push and pull strategy in which the company will use a push strategy to move products, and then a pull strategy to encourage purchasing from retailers.

Let's dive into a few recommendations for best sales promotion practices that you can use regardless of which strategy you're trying out.

Sales promotion techniques

- **Know your audience:** Are you catering to new customers or existing customers? Are you looking to promote a new product or increase sales on an existing product? These questions will help you choose which sales promotion is best for your company at that time.
- **Emphasize scarcity and/or urgency:** Your sales promotion should always be short-term, but it's important to emphasize why. Customers will be more motivated to buy if there's a risk of running out of time or running out of product.
- **Align your sales promotion with your company:** Consistency is always key in every aspect of sales, and it's no different with a sales promotion. If you specialize in long-term products, such as electronics, then it doesn't make sense to offer customers a subscription package when they're only going to purchase new products every few years.

Sales promotion activities

- **Run promotions in alignment with key dates for your market:** Use your annual sales analytics to know when your customers are most likely to buy and schedule your promotions around them. Michael's Craft Store is a great example of this. They excel at marketing holiday sales promotions on themed decorative items towards the beginning and end of each holiday season.
- **Reward your customers with a loyalty program:** A loyalty program is a simple way to tell your customers you care and it can be formatted in almost any way. Even if you're not in a position to give discounts, you can use a loyalty program to give customers a heads up regarding sales, new products, and company milestones.

How CRM software can drive your sales promotions

The key to sales promotion success is knowing your customer base and having a reliable handle on your finances, revenue, and team statistics.

UNIT-V

SALES PROMOTIONAL PROGRAMME

Developing The Sales Promotion Program

The marketers must make several other decisions in order to define the full sales promotion program. First, the marketers must decide on the size of the incentives. If the promotion is to succeed, a certain minimum incentive is necessary. A large incentive will generate more sales response. Marketers also must set conditions for participation. Incentives might be offered to everyone or only to selected groups.

Then marketers must decide how to promote and distribute the promotion plan itself. A 50-cents-off coupon could be given out in a package, at a store, by mail, or in an advertisement. Each distribution process involves a different level of cost and reach. Increasingly, marketers are combination of several media into a total campaign concept. The length of the promotion is also very important. If the time period of sales promotion is too short, many prospects (who may not be buying during that time) will be missed. Vice versa if the promotion period runs too long, the deal will lose some of its “act now” force.

Evaluation is also very important. Yet many companies fail to evaluate their sales promotion plans, and others evaluate them only apparently. The most general evaluation method is to compare sales before, during, and after the promotion. Suppose a company has a 6 percent market share before the promotion, which jump to 10 percent during the promotion campaign, falls to 5 percent right after, and rises 7 percent later on. The promotion plans seem to have attracted new attempts and encouraged more buying by current customers. After the promotion, sales fell as consumers used up their inventories. The long run rise to 7 percent

shows that company gained some new users. If the brand's share had returned to the old level, the promotion would have changed only the timing of demand rather than the total demand.

Consumer research would also show the kinds of people who responded to the promotion and what they did after the promotion ended. Surveys can provide information regarding consumers and their attitude towards promotional campaigns and sales.

Undoubtedly, sales promotion plays vital role in the total promotion mix. To use it well, the marketers must classify the sales promotion objectives, select the best tools, design the well described sales promotion plan, implement the plan, and evaluate the outcome of it. Moreover, sales promotion must be coordinated carefully with other promotion mix elements within the incorporated marketing communications program.

6 Stages Involved in Sales Promotion Planning

The main stages which is involved in sales promotion planning are: 1. Establishment of objectives, 2. Selection of promotional tools, 3. Planning the sales-promotion programme, 4. Pre-testing, 5. Implementation and 6. Evaluation

As in the case of advertising, effective sales promotion involves an on-going process with a number of stages.

1. Establishment of objectives:

Sales-promotion objectives vary according to the target market. If the target is the customer, objectives could include the encouragement of increased usage or the building of trial among non-users or other brand users. For intermediaries, objectives could be to encourage off-season sales or offsetting competitive promotions. Sales-promotion activity could also be aimed at internal personnel, making up part of the reward system

2. Selection of promotional tools:

Promotional objectives form the basis for selecting the most appropriate sales-promotion tools. The cost and effectiveness of each tool must be assessed with regard to achieving these objectives in respect of each target market. The tools available to the service marketer are described in more detail in the next section.

3. Planning the sales-promotion programme:

The major decisions that need to be made when designing the sales-promotion programme relate to the timing of the promotion and how long this tool is to be used. Also important are the size of incentive, rules for eligibility and, of course, the overall budget for the promotion.

4. Pre-testing:

This needs to be undertaken to ensure that potentially expensive problems are discovered before the full launch of a promotion. Testing in selected market segments can highlight problems of ambiguity, response rates and give an indication of cost effectiveness.

5. Implementation:

The programme for implementation must include two important time factors First, it must indicate the 'lead time'- the time necessary to bring the programme up to the point where the incentive is made available to the public. Second, the 'sell in time' which is the period of time from the date of release to when approximately 90-95 per cent, of incentive material has been received by potential customers.

6. Evaluation:

The performance of the promotion needs to be assessed against the objectives set. If objectives are specific and quantifiable, measurement would seem to be easy. However, extraneous factors could account for the apparent success of many sales-promotion activities.

For example, competitive actions or seasonal variations may have influenced customers' decision making. It can also be extremely difficult to separate out the effects of sales-promotion activity from other promotional activity-or indeed from other marketing-mix changes.

What is pre testing in sales promotion evaluation process?

The pre-testing evaluation technique allows a company's marketing department to determine the effectiveness of a promotional strategy. The company may choose to use simulation as a pre-testing technique to test consumer appeal, consumer awareness, repeat purchases and the sense of value.

What are the steps in pre-testing?

Steps

- Step 1: Outline Pretest Objectives. ...
- Step 2: Choose the Pretest Method. ...
- Step 3: Plan the Pretest. ...
- Step 4: Develop Pretesting Guide. ...
- Step 5: Develop Questions. ...
- Step 6: Conduct Pretest. ...
- Step 7: Analyze Data and Interpret Results. ...
- Step 8: Summarize the Results.

What is sales evaluation process?

A sales evaluation is essentially the analysis of sales performance among your salespeople or the sales performance of a price or marketing change or campaign. An effective analysis will be able to identify the strengths and weaknesses of either the people or the processes.